

Writing Connected Sentences

Writing practice

Conjunctions

- We join sentences in many different ways. We use ‘and’, ‘but’, ‘however’, and many such connectors to join two shorter sentences and make them longer. In this section we are going to learn how to join sentences with linking words or conjunctions. In this unit you will learn about ‘conjunctions’. A conjunction is a connecting word that connects parts of a sentence. We will look at only two types of conjunctions:
 - 1 Coordinating Conjunctions
 - 2 Subordinating Conjunctions

Coordinating Conjunctions:

- Coordinating conjunctions join single words, or they may join groups of words, but remember that they always join similar elements, for example:
 - subject +subject
 - verb phrase +verb phrase
 - sentence +sentence

Coordinating Conjunctions

- And
- but
- or
- yet
- for
- nor
- so

AND

- Tahir sent in his applications and waited for a response.
- Use your credit cards frequently and you'll soon find yourself deep in debt.
- Lilacs and violets are usually purple.
- Nauman spent his summer vacations studying basic math and reading comprehension.

B U T

- Jamil lost a fortune in the stock market, but he is able to live quite comfortably.
- This is a useful rule, but difficult to remember.
- I love to drink tea, but hate soft drinks.
- This job provides a lot of training opportunities, but offers a poor salary package

OR

- You can study hard for this exam or you can fail.
- We can eat chicken tonight, or we can just eat some Daal Chawal.
- We can ask the locals to guide us, or we can buy a map of the area.
- A lot of people believe in a motto: 'Live free or die'.

Subordinating Conjunctions:

- A subordinating conjunction is sometimes called a dependent word or subordinator, and it comes at the beginning of a subordinate or dependent clause.

Common Subordinating Conjunctions

Common Subordinating Conjunctions			
After	because	although	If
Before	since	though	Unless
When	now that	even though	only if
While	As	whereas	whether or not
Since	in order that	While	even if
Until	So		in case (that)

Read some examples that illustrate the use of **subordinate conjunctions**:

Conjunction	Sample sentences
After	After we finish taking the test, we are going out to eat.
Since	Since we have lived in Lahore, we have gone to every historical sight
While	While I was waiting in line for the museum to open, I ate my lunch
Although	Although the line was long and the wait over two hours, the visit was worth it
even if	Even if you have already bought your ticket, you will still need to wait in line
Because	I love Guljee's works because he uses colour so brilliantly

Which conjunction fits best in the sentence?

1. I am hungry _____ I don't want to eat.

- but
- so
- after
- before
- or

Do you want pizza _____ a burger?

- than
- so
- while
- as
- or

I would tell you _____ I knew.

- than
- and
- unless
- if
- or

Passage for Conjunction Practice

Although the day was beautiful, a sudden storm brewed, so we quickly packed up our picnic. My friends and I had been enjoying the park, but the dark clouds appeared without warning. We didn't want to get soaked, so we hurried to our car. As soon as we were safely inside, the rain started to fall heavily, and the wind howled around us. Neither the weather nor the sudden change of plans ruined our afternoon, because we decided to go to a cozy cafe instead. We ordered hot chocolate and pastries, and it was a perfect way to end our outing, even though it wasn't the day we had planned.

- This passage includes various conjunctions, including:
- **Coordinating Conjunctions:** (joining two independent clauses):
and, but, so
- **Subordinating Conjunctions:** (joining an independent and a dependent clause): although, as soon as, because, if, unless, when, while, whereas, after, before, since, when
- **Correlative Conjunctions:** (pairs of conjunctions): not only... but also, neither... nor

Practice Activity

- **Identify:** all the conjunctions in the passage above.
- **Categorize:** each conjunction as coordinating, subordinating, or correlative.
- **Explain:** the relationship the conjunction creates between the words or clauses it joins.
- **Check:** your work using the examples provided in the resources for each type of conjunction.

Passage 1: Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)

Complete the blanks with one of the coordinating conjunctions: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so.

Maria wanted to go to the park, _____ she knew she had a lot of homework to do.

She considered finishing her chores first, _____ she also wanted to help her mother bake a cake.

Her brother, Tom, didn't want to go outside _____ did he want to help with the baking; he preferred to play video games inside.

Tom was not hungry, _____ he still ate all the cookies.

Maria finished all her homework, _____ she was finally able to go to the park.

Passage 2: Subordinating Conjunctions

complete the blanks with one of the subordinating conjunctions: after, although, because, before, since, unless, until, while.

1. _____ the sun began to set, the children were called inside for dinner.
2. The family ate together every night, _____ it was a very important tradition for them.
3. The food was delicious, _____ the dog sat patiently under the table, hoping for a dropped morsel.
4. _____ they finished eating, they watched a movie together.
5. _____ the movie was not their first choice, they still enjoyed it.
6. They were not allowed to stay up late, _____ it was a school night.

Passage 3: Correlative Conjunctions

Complete the blanks with one of the paired correlative conjunctions: both/and, either/or, neither/nor, not only/but also.

1. My friend Alex is a great storyteller.

2. He is able to make his audience _____ laugh _____ cry with his vivid descriptions.

3. Last weekend, Alex told us a scary story about a haunted house.

4. _____ did we feel frightened by his tale, _____ we were also impressed by his creativity.

5. He explained that a character in his story had to choose to face the ghost _____ run away from it, with no other options.

6. The house in the story was a decrepit old place, where _____ the doors _____ the windows were securely locked